PROCESS DEFINITION DOCUMENT (PDD)

Project 1 • SAP Vendor Payment Process Automation

Document purpose

This document describes the current business process, the proposed automation flow, business rules, exceptions and operational assumptions for automating vendor-payment ledger generation and reporting.

1. Process overview

Item	Description
Process name	SAP Vendor Payment Process Automation
Business area	Finance / Accounts Payable
Automation platform	Automation Anywhere v11
Target application	SAP GUI / SAP recording-based interaction
Main outputs	Ledger report and finance reporting file
Reported baseline	Manual workflows; repetitive work estimated at about 60% of manual effort
Reported benefit	About 35% fewer manual data-entry errors; reporting improved from two-day turnaround to same-day delivery

2. Business objective

Reduce repetitive manual effort in vendor-payment and master-data activities by automating the agreed SAP steps for ledger generation and report preparation. Improve consistency, reduce rekeying errors, and make finance reports available on the same business day where source data and approvals are ready.

3. Scope

In scope

- Open SAP and navigate to the approved vendor-payment / ledger reporting workflow.
- Apply agreed date filters and reporting parameters.

- Read and validate required input values before processing.
- Run the approved SAP recording or transaction steps.
- Generate, save and organize the ledger/report output.
- Perform basic output checks and log the run result.
- Notify the designated finance contact of completion or an exception.

Out of scope

- Changing vendor master data or bank details without an authorized human approval.
- Approving invoices, releasing payments or overriding SAP financial controls.
- Making accounting-policy decisions or resolving disputed invoices.
- Changing SAP configuration, access roles or production controls.
- Automatically retrying transactions that may have posted financial entries unless a safe retry is confirmed.

4. Stakeholders and responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Finance / Accounts Payable	Owns process rules, validates report content, handles business exceptions.
SAP functional / application team	Confirms transaction paths, screen fields, access and SAP behavior.
RPA developer / support	Builds and maintains the bot, logs failures, supports controlled deployment.
Process owner	Approves requirements, acceptance criteria and operational handover.

5. Inputs and prerequisites

- Authorized SAP user account with least-privilege access to the required transactions and reports.
- Approved reporting period / date range and any required company code or vendor selection criteria.
- Stable SAP GUI environment and Automation Anywhere v11 runtime/runner availability.
- Known output folder, file naming convention and access permissions.
- Business-approved validation rules and an identified owner for exception handling.

6. Proposed process steps

Step	Action	Expected result
1	Start the bot and read run parameters.	Run ID, date range and output location are captured.
2	Check prerequisites and SAP availability.	Bot proceeds only when the required environment is available.
3	Log in to SAP using an approved credential mechanism.	Authenticated session is available; credentials are not written to logs.
4	Navigate to the approved SAP recording / report transaction.	Correct transaction or screen is open.
5	Enter date filters and required selection criteria.	Criteria match the approved run parameters.
6	Execute the report or ledger-generation action.	SAP returns the expected report data or a clear exception.
7	Validate report status, date range and basic completeness.	Output passes defined checks or is flagged for review.
8	Save/export the report to the approved location.	Output file is created with the agreed naming convention.
9	Write completion status and notify the process owner.	Audit trail records success/failure and the output location.

7. Business rules and controls

- Use only approved date filters and selection criteria; do not silently substitute a different period.
- Do not alter vendor bank details, payment amounts or approval status.
- If SAP displays a warning, posting message, unexpected screen or ambiguous result, stop and route to a human owner.
- Never log passwords, authentication tokens, bank account details or unnecessary personal/vendor-sensitive data.
- Do not overwrite an existing report unless the business-approved naming/versioning rule permits it.
- Record the run timestamp, run ID, parameters, result status and error summary.

8. Exceptions and recovery

Exception	Bot response	Owner / next action
SAP unavailable / login failure	Stop safely; log technical error without secrets.	RPA support / SAP support
Required field missing	Do not execute report; record validation failure.	Finance to provide correct parameters
No data returned	Save status; do not label as a successful populated report.	Finance to confirm whether zero records are expected
Unexpected SAP screen or popup	Capture safe diagnostic details and stop.	RPA support / SAP team
Export or file-save failure	Do not report success; log location and error.	RPA support
Report validation failure	Mark output as needing review; avoid distribution as final.	Finance / process owner

9. Outputs and evidence

- Ledger/report output in the agreed file format and location.
- Run log containing start/end time, run ID, status, selected period and exception summary.
- Evidence of validation results and any human review required.
- Completion notification to the designated finance contact.

10. Assumptions and open points

- Exact SAP transaction codes, screen names, field names and export format were not provided in the source brief and must be confirmed with the SAP team.
- The 60%, 35% and turnaround figures are project-reported outcomes and should be validated against baseline measurements before external use.
- Business owner must confirm run frequency, date-filter logic, file naming, retention period and notification channel.
- Credentials must be stored and retrieved through the organization's approved secure mechanism.

11. Acceptance criteria

- The bot processes the approved reporting period and criteria accurately.

- The report is generated and saved to the approved location with no unintended overwrite.
- Output checks and run logs are completed for success and failure paths.
- Exceptions stop safely and are routed to the designated owner.
- Finance validates the output against a known-good manual run and signs off before production use.